

The Border | |

Borders are metaphysical concepts +as well as+ geopolitical structures that determine:
 who? may enter? who? must wait? who? is
 refused?

2 states: Death Rebirth

The border || is a stop sign until it's decided who? is allowed to be and who? isn't.

The border || marks the space where one form ends and another must begin.

The border || is the site where the displaced is suspended between death and post-death, between the life left behind and the life not yet real. This threshold is an extended period of a series of moments. It stretches across checkpoints, screenings, interviews, waiting room, waiting room, waiting room.

The border || exposes the displaced to forms of scrutiny *the other* never encounters.

The border || shapes the displaced's sense of self long before && long after the physical crossing.

Crossing the border involves passing, transforming, detaching, and unrooting.

Crossing the border requires:

- the shedding of certain attachments
- the forced acquisition of new ones.

The border is therefore a chasm that disfigures many realities.

The Ghost:

Idea of:	Identities that linger after rupture
	The life that continues after a 'death'
	Displacement as a <i>haunting</i>

The haunting produces a form of survival that is neither fully living nor fully gone. After rupture, identities do not disappear. They persist in altered form, lingering at the edges of the present like unfinished narratives. The former life transforms into a phantom limb. It aches without being touched. It moves even after the body has been severed from it. It continues as a memory that haunts the displaced, suspended, preserved in fragments, accessible only through recollection and digital screens. The displaced inhabit a double temporality: the present of survival and the past like a splinter in your mind insisting to be remembered.

The Alien

The alien occupies a space between the supernatural and the bureaucratic.

In popular imagination, the alien is otherworldly, unfamiliar, estranged.

In legal language, the term alien performs a similar function.

It marks the migrant as someone fundamentally outside the category of the /national/ self.

It transforms one into a classification that is both present and not fully recognized.

To be labeled an alien is to be positioned as a being whose origins are elsewhere,

, whose presence requires justification,

, whose belonging is always provisional.

This language does not merely describe.

It produces a form of estrangement that shapes how migrants are perceived and how they perceive themselves.

The alien becomes a figure suspended between worlds,

, not because of inherent difference,

, but because THE LAW constructs them as such.

Border Survival Guide for the Alien (BSGA):

FOLD UP THE FLAG:

Place the flag in the red box given to you at the passing,

15 days later:

You lose your mother,

If you lose your mother tongue, the recovery period is slightly longer.

LOCATE FRICTION:

Identify the friction points, generally the awareness of existing friction points is better than the passive co-existing with the uneasiness, you must look at the rash and predict potential future spots, use a marker to track the progress of the rash, if the speed accelerates, act accordingly.

DAILY MIND SWEEP:

Internally tune yourself into an emotional register that will allow you not to bite anyone's head off.

AT THE MEETING:

1. Get your Ticket from the Ticket Machine.
2. Carry the Ticket like a stone in your mouth.
3. Chew on it till one of your molar teeth falls.
4. Wash it and explain to the agent working at the desk that you need the tooth certified and apostilled BEFORE you leave the establishment (otherwise it will cost an arm and a leg the second time in addition to another molar).

BEFORE SLEEP:

Close your eyes and focus every cell of you to reflect your purpose from inside you to the world, each cell in you is a singular panel in a solar power plant in a desert field, looking down from above each panel gets rotated the perfect angle, going from individual flickers to a pool of sunlight too blinding to examine, like that your cells will flood your purpose into reality.

AT ALL TIMES:

Breathe: Inhale nose, exhale mouth.